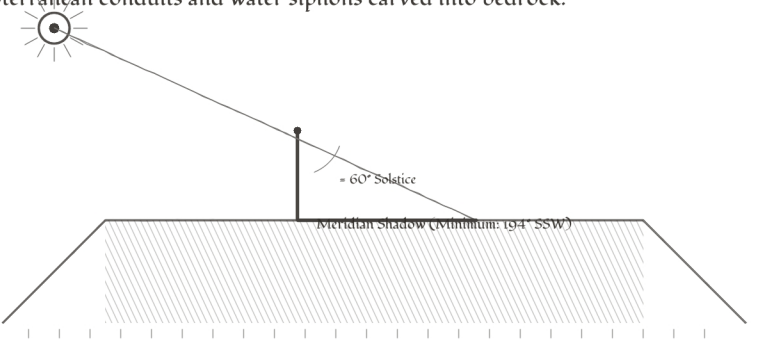
The Solstice Horizon

Solar Geometry & Meridian Shadows of Mesa del Sol

I. The Meridian Shadow

When the sun reaches solar noon above the Great Mesa, the shadow cast by the jagged rim contracts to its absolute minimum. It is at this exact moment that the terrestrial dial functions: shadows do not merely indicate time, but point toward buried subterranean conduits and water siphons carved into bedrock.



II. Thermal Silence

Between the fourth hour of morning and the eighth of afternoon, the furnace heat suppresses every sound. The birds fall still; the wind drops to a trembling murmur. It is in this thermal silence that the sandstone speaks—faint cracking sounds echoing from the fractures beneath our boots like the ticking of an immense clock.

III. The Warning of Hermes

Hermes cautions us: do not venture beyond the northern bluff without calculating the shadow angle. A single misstep upon the crumbling sandstone shelf will send man and beast into the abyss. Follow only the shadow that aligns with the Al-Qibla heading.